



One of the earliest supporting characters in the Iron Man comic book was Edwin Jarvis, Tony Stark's loyal butler. Aiding Director Jon Favreau's desire to bring Jarvis into the 21st century, Meinerding set out to adapt him as a ubiquitous A.I. construct. Robert Downey, Jr.'s fascination with the mystical quality of pentagonal shapes led him to request their addition to the Jarvis keypad design (above).

The Jarvis console (center, right) was to be Jarvis' physical heart. One of the main design paradigms for the illustrator was to make it look like it could, in Meinerding's words, "break interestingly" — i.e., have a dense, glassy configuration that would look spectacular on film as potential collateral damage in an on-screen battle.